

A syllabic consonant is a phonetic element that normally patterns as a consonant, but may fill a vowel slot in a syllable.

In other words a syllabic consonant is a consonant that can form an entire syllable on its own, without any vowels.

Usually, a syllable contains a vowel.

Syllabic /l/ and /ŋ/ typically occur in an unstressed syllable immediately following the alveolar consonants, /t/, /s/, /z/, as well as /d/.

Examples: :bottle /bɑ:təl/, cattle /'kætl/, chisel /s / cotton /kɑ:tn:/, button /bʌtn/.

listen /lɪsn/, fasten /fæsn/

risen /rizn/, prison 'prɪzn/

saddle /'sædl/, poodle /pu:d/

sadden /'sædn/, burden /bʌdn/

Syllabic /l/ can also follow /st/ or plain /n/ or-- Examples:

pistol /pɪstl/

tunnel /tʌnl/

mantle /mæntl

Syllabic consonants are consonants that can form a syllable on their own, replacing schwa sounds in unstressed syllables.

Though /l/ and /n/ are the noticeable syllabic consonant in English syllable /l/ ... The syllabic /n/ is common after alveolar plosives and fricatives.

syllabic consonants l/ and /n

Syllabic consonants are consonants that form a syllable by themselves, without a vowel sound. In English, the sounds /n/ and /l/ can act as syllabic consonants, most commonly in unstressed



syllables.

Syllabic /n/

The /n/ sound carries the syllable after an alveolar consonant like /t/ or /d/.

Examples:

button: /'bʌt.n̩ /

listen: /'lɪs.n̩ /

sadden: /'sæd.n̩ /

often: /'ɒf.n̩ / (note that "often" has a silent 't' and the 'n' is syllabic)

didn't: /dɪd.n̩ /

Syllabic /l/

How it works: The /l/ sound carries the syllable after certain consonants like /t/, /d/, /s/, /z/, /n/, or /nt/.

Examples:

bottle: /'bɒ.t.l̩ /

saddle: /'sæd.l̩ /

puddle: /'pʌd.l̩ /

pistol: /'pɪs.təl/

mantle: /'mæn.t̩l̩ /

tunnel: /'tʌn.l̩ /

Important considerations

Unstressed syllables: Syllabic consonants usually occur in unstressed syllables.

Phonetic transcription: In phonetic transcriptions, a small vertical line under the consonant (e.g., [n̩] or [l̩]) indicates that it is syllabic.

Natural speech: While you might see a vowel written in words like "button," native speakers produce the word without an extra vowel sound, making the syllabic consonant the only "vowel" sound in that syllable.

syllabic consonant, the syllabic consonant may



either be retained as such or it simply becomes

the initial consonant of the extra syllable.

Examples:

Listening /lisɪnɪn/

going /'ɡoʊɪn/

Pronouncing Syllabic Consonants: /l/ and /n/ in English ...

Syllabic Consonants: /l/ and /n/ · 1. sound the final /n/ · 2. avoid putting in a vowel before the
Examples of consonants followed by the /j/ sound

/j/ sound spelled with "u"

In many words, the /j/ sound is represented by the letter "u" and follows a consonant.

cute

during

music

popular

tune

value

computer

Common consonant + w blends

dw: dwell, dwarf, dwindle

sw: sweep, swing, swift

tw: twist, twin, twelve

Words with initial consonant + w

Dw-: dwell, dwarf, dwindle, dwelt

Sw-: sweet, sweat, sweep, swim, swing, swoosh, swoop

Tw-: twist, twig, twelve, twin, twine, twenty, twirl

Qu- (/kw/ sound): quit, quiet, queen, quiz, quick, quilt

